Templates with Twig

Aims

Learn how to use the Twig template engine in Symfony projects

Objectives

- Install and learn about Twig
- Create a three-level template
- Render about page using the template
- Additional templating exercises

Twig

Installation
composer require template

New file: config/bundles.php -> new bundle added and enabled (previously manual process involving AppKernel)

New directory: templates

Documentation
https://twig.symfony.com/doc/3.x/ (https://twig.symfony.com/doc/3.x/)

Templating

Create a three-level template
recommended for medium to complex applications

https://symfony.com/doc/current/templates.html
(https://symfony.com/doc/current/templates.html)

corresponding files to be placed in folder "templates"

- base template file (base.html.twig)
- layout template file (controller_name/layout.html.twig)
- page template file(s) (controller_name/action_name.html.twig)

Use the template
Modify about page controller from last week

Controller class needs to extend AbstractController (for convenience features)

Call render function in controller and return response (object)

Additional tools
Lint - check Twig syntax

php bin/console lint:twig (check all templates)

php bin/console lint:twig templates/controller_name/ (check specific directory)

php bin/console lint:twig templates/controller_name/action_name.html.twig (check specific file)

bin/console debug:twig (shows a list of twig functions, filters, globals and tests)

Additional exercises

1. Iterate over a sequence
Create an array in your controller, hand it over to the template and get it to show all elements in an unordered list

$team = array("Andrei", "Kingsley", "Julie", "Kacper", "Rebecca", "Junaid", "Jesse", "Oliver", "Nathan");

https://twig.symfony.com/doc/3.x/tags/for.html (https://twig.symfony.com/doc/3.x/tags/for.html)

2. Apply filters
Convert the names in the above list to all upper case

Count and display the number of team members

see the Twig documentation for a full list of filters:
https://twig.symfony.com/doc/3.x/filters/index.html
(https://twig.symfony.com/doc/3.x/filters/index.html)

3. Handle assets (the basic way)
Improve the presentation of your about page by adding some layout/CSS styling/images

Basic approach -> place and link resources in folder public

What does the Twig asset function do/why should we use it?

composer require symfony/asset